



STUDENT ORGANIZATION CONSTITUTION AND BYLAW REQUIREMENTS

A constitution and bylaws are written to guide an organization in its operations and activities. These documents should be clearly worded, intentionally structured, and kept up-to-date to meet the needs of the student organization. All student organizations must post the most updated version of their constitution and bylaws on the organization's syncDIN page.

The constitution:

Establishes the broad structure of the organization and fundamental principles of the organization

- Should be straight forward and comprehensive
- Should be difficult to amend

The bylaws:

Outline the rules of procedures for an organization

- Should be consistent with the constitution
- Tends to be easier to amend than the constitution

The following information is intended to be a guide to assist you in writing or revising your organization's constitution. There are many ways to structure an organization, so feel free to write your constitution and bylaws to fit the needs of your organization. However, each item listed below must be included somewhere within the document in order to be a recognized or sponsored student organization. Statements in red must be included, word-for-word, as written.

CONSTITUTION

Article I: Name

"The formal name of this organization shall be [Furman Club Gymnastics]."

Article II: Purpose

"The purpose of [Furman Club Gymnastics] shall be [to create an inclusive community where every student, regardless of their previous experience, can enjoy gymnastics, build confidence, and improve their physical fitness. To create a space where people eager to learn skills can safely and conferrable be able to do so]

Article III: Affiliations

If applicable, what University departments is your organization affiliated with? Furman university
Is your organization affiliated with any local, state, national, or international organizations? If so, what does that relationship look like? Yes, it would be affiliated with Foothills gymnastics center. That would be where we would practice once a week whatever time the gym would like us, usually from 3:30- to-6:00.

The following statement must be included in your constitution:

This organization is a recognized organization at Furman University and adheres to all University policies as set forth in the Furman University Student Handbook.

Article IV: Membership

Who is eligible for membership?
Each individual in the club

The following statement must be included within your constitution:

In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

Article V: Officers

What are the officer/leadership titles?

I would be the president of Gymnastics Club which does most of the work coordinating and taking with the gym and the second most important job would be VP.

What are the qualifications to serve as an officer?

The qualifications for VP would be willing and able to assist and help me out with coordinating practices. The VP and the President would have to go to each practice.

What is the term of each office?

-A year but I would stay the president until I leave campus and the VP would likely stay the same.

Article VI: Advisor

What is the general relationship of the advisor to the organization?

Help me out with anything if I need it like with the invoices.

Remember, advisors may not have decision-making or voting authority within the organization, as organizations are student-initiated and student-run.

Article VII: Meetings

How often will meetings be held?

Weekly practices- likely on a Wednesday or a Friday

Article VIII: Finance

How will the organization receive funding?

-Through the money Furman gives our club

Are active members expected to pay dues and, if so, how much and when are those to be paid?

-no active members do not have to pay dues

Article IX: Amendments

What is the process for amending the constitution?

-I get the club up and established. I contact the gym and ask them how much it would be to work out once a week for 3 hours and we get an invoice from them. The gym we have worked with before and they would have a couch for us.

BYLAWS

Article I: Membership

Will there be different categories of membership and, if so, what are the rights of different members?

no

What does the selection/application process include?

You must have work out clothes to practice in and a hair tie.

What are requirements for membership (financial obligations, minimum gpa, etc.)?

Must keep track of how many practices we do and how many hours we are there for each practice so we can pay the gym at the end of the semester.

What is the process for removing a member?

The president would remove them from the GroupMe and be told they are not welcome back

Article II: Selection of Officers

How are officers selected/elected?

I will make a sign-up sheet and the member of the club can sign up on their own.

What are the primary duties of each office?

The main duties go to the president who runs the organization, speaks to the gym, and coordinates practices. President will also keep track of time and hours of practices held

The duties of the VP would be to help out the president with extra activities and attend each practice.

As the club grows, there will be room for other officials handed out.

What procedure should be followed in the event of a vacancy?

-the president would pick the next best candidate.

What is the process for removing an officer from position?

Go to the advisor, or the club sports office and make it official.

Article III: Selection of Advisor

How is the advisor selected?

I ask a professor that I am close to and trust.

What are the provisions for removal of an advisor?

I would tell them that I have picked someone else as an advisor.

Article IV: Committees

What committees (or similar) will be established?

-President

-Vp

-chief financial officer

What are the functions and duties of each?

-President runs the organization, speaks to the gym, and coordinates practices. President will also keep track of time and hours of practices held

-VP would be to help out the president with extra activities and attend each practice.

-the chief financial officer would keep track of how much money we have to spend and how many practices we can attend

What is the process for establishing ad-hoc committees?

The president assigns as who they see fit. Or create a sign-up sheet and members can join.

Article V: Rules of Order

How will business be conducted?

Work with the foothills gymnastics center and establish a good relationship with them, which Furman already has. And be respectful with their equipment and gym.

How will internal conflicts be resolved?

Talk to the manager of the gymnastics center and resolve issues as see fit

The following statement must be included within your constitution:

Organizations may not address a member's violations of university policy via internal standards boards or other accountability mechanisms without prior approval of the Dean of Students Office. Conduct expectations unique to membership in the organization and that do not overlap or otherwise interfere with university authority may be addressed with the written approval of the AVP/Dean of Students or designee. Groups affiliated with national organizations that have established guidance and procedures over disciplinary matters, may follow the directive of those national organizations with regard to member conduct but must do so with written approval of the university.

To address alleged member conduct that does not violate university policy (e.g. meeting attendance, enrollment status, upholding organization mission, etc.), organizations should work with their faculty or staff advisor to develop a process for addressing such behavior that is fair and equitable. This process should be clearly outlined in your bylaws. Student organizations with concerns about the behavior of a member should submit a report through one of the various reporting options offered by the University.

Article VI: Amendments

What is the process for amending the bylaws?

Speak with the club sports council and get it all set up and if there is a problem work with them to work it out.